

Lesson Plan

Topic: Columbus: Hero or Villain?

Teacher:	Ed Rush	Date:	21 June, 2026
Class:	M3	Duration:	46 minutes
CEFR Level:	B2	Lesson Shape:	R (Receptive Skills)
Materials:	• BTN video: Bridge Walk Anniversary (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SCW0BWf_Jys) • Oxford Discover Futures 3 Student Book pp. 38–39 • Oxford Discover Futures 3 Teacher's Guide pp. 60–61 • Slide deck		
Slideshow URL:	https://elwrrush.github.io/lesson-plan-writer/M3-COLUMBUS/index.html		

Lesson Aim

Main aim: By the end of the lesson, learners will have practised reading for opinion and identifying facts vs opinions in a text about Christopher Columbus.

Subsidiary aim: Learners will have listened for gist from a video about colonisation and reconciliation, and expressed and supported their own opinions using a structured framework.

Lesson Stages

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Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
STAGE 1: Lead-in – BTN Video			
10 min	To introduce the topic of colonisation and activate students' existing knowledge through a news video	• Show the 3 gist questions on screen (not on handout): • Read through each question, clarify that these are gist questions – main ideas only • Play the BTN video "Bridge Walk Anniversary" (2 min 27 sec) once • Students write brief notes individually while watching • Pairs compare notes and agree on answers • Whole-class feedback: elicit answers for each gist question and build a shared understanding on the board	T-Ss → Indiv → Pair → T-Ss

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
		Transition: "Colonisation is still being talked about today – partly because of figures like Christopher Columbus. Let's look at the man who started it all."	
STAGE 2: Columbus Elicitation			
3 min	To activate prior knowledge about Christopher Columbus before reading	- Show the Columbus image on screen - Elicit: Who is this man? What is he famous for? - Board key ideas: Italian explorer, 1492, "discovered" America - Briefly acknowledge the controversy: "Some people call him a hero. Others call him a villain. Today we're going to look a little deeper."	T-Ss
STAGE 3: Pre-teach Vocabulary			
5 min	To ensure understanding of five key words needed for the reading text	- Present 5 target words on screen with example sentences: - Check comprehension with concept questions: - Students write the words in their notebooks - Quick drill: say each word, students repeat chorally	T-Ss → Indiv
STAGE 4: Reading – Exercises 1–3			
10 min	To read for main ideas and identify each writer's opinion about Columbus	- Students open their textbooks to p. 38–39 - Ex 1: Read the introduction and answer in pairs: - Ex 2: Read the two comments (Anna Craig + Guillermo Delgado) and identify each writer's overall opinion of Columbus - Ex 3: Answer the comprehension questions	Indiv → Pair → T-Ss
STAGE 5: Facts vs Opinions			
8 min	To distinguish between fact and opinion and apply this skill to the reading text	- Pedagogical introduction: "A fact can be proven – it's true for everyone. An opinion is what someone thinks or feels – different people can disagree." - Use a Columbus-related example to demonstrate: - Read the Reading Strategy box (p. 38) aloud - Ex 4: Students classify 8 statements as fact or opinion	T-Ss → Indiv → Pair → T-Ss

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
		Extension: Elicit one more fact and one more opinion about Columbus from the class	
STAGE 6: Structured Opinions			
5 min	To learn and practise a structured framework for expressing and supporting opinions	- Present the structure on screen: - Explain that evidence can include personal stories or examples: "When you give an opinion in a discussion, you can use a story to support it – think about when it happened, who was involved, what happened, where, how, and why." - Teacher models with a structured opinion: - Students write their own structured opinion about Columbus using the framework - Volunteers share with the class (time permitting)	T-Ss → Indiv
STAGE 7: Think-Pair-Share – Exercise 8.1			
5 min	To discuss and evaluate how the same person can be seen as both a hero and a villain	- Display Exercise 8, Question 1: - Think (1 min): Students write their own ideas silently - Pair (2 min): Pairs discuss their ideas, using the structured opinion framework from Stage 6 - Share (2 min): Elicit 3–4 pairs to share their ideas with the class	Indiv → Pair → T-Ss